

CANONICAL LESSON

Evaluate Place-Based Programmes

Decision-centred foundations for accountable sector intelligence

Production Unit	PU-B07-C64
Notebook	V7_D_N14
Status	Controlled educational draft v0.1
Data boundary	Synthetic instructional data only

Central decision: Evaluate place-based programmes through theory, spatial and temporal counterfactuals, implementation, spillovers, displacement, equity, costs, uncertainty, and local context.

Learning outcomes

Why this matters

Simple before-and-after area comparisons can mistake population change or spillovers for programme impact and conceal who lost.

The analytical workflow is useful only when evidence, uncertainty, authority, and action are connected explicitly. The model supports professional judgement; it does not replace accountable institutional authority.

Worked cross-sector example

An evaluation tests whether neighbourhood improvement reflects programme contribution, wider trends, displacement, or changes in who lives there.

Boundary: The example supports learning and review. It does not constitute an official statistic, eligibility determination, enforcement action, clinical judgement, or operational authorization.

Practice and reflection

- 1.
- Test parallel pre-trends.
- 2.
- Detect displacement.

- 3.
- Report distributional effects.

Answer key

- 1.
- Compare several pre-period slopes and event-study patterns, recognizing that passing tests cannot prove the assumption.
- 2.
- Track population composition, rents, evictions, business turnover, and movement into adjacent areas.
- 3.
- Show outcomes separately by tenure, income, gender, disability, age, and location with uncertainty and participation.

Operational readiness checklist

- Purpose and decision owner are named.
- Evidence definitions, provenance, and lawful access are documented.
- Uncertainty and abstention are visible.
- Human review, escalation, monitoring, incident response, and retirement are assigned.
- Equity, accessibility, security, and sector-specific approval are complete.